Jonathan Pufall

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As a performer and a finance student, I've seen both sides of the stage. I want to build the business behind great stories, ensuring artists are supported and connected with the audiences who need them. That connection is where I believe real value is created for all.

Education

University of Wisconsin-Madison **Madison, WI**
Major: BBA, Finance, Investment and Banking | Certificate: Theater and Drama *Expected May 2027*
GPA: 3.57 / 4.00 (Dean's List, twice recognized)

Professional Experience

Sparke **Madison, WI**
Founder *October 2026 – Present*
- Founded an artist discovery, collaboration, and fan engagement platform connecting emerging performers with audiences and industry professionals, giving artists a free path to fans and opportunities to share and grow their work
- Lead market research, architect the product tech stack and trust-and-safety framework, and build early relationships with artists, studios, theater companies, and university arts organizations ahead of a 2027 pilot program

Client Magnet CRM **Los Angeles, CA (Remote)**
Co-Founder/Developer, Strategy & Finance *May 2025 – Present*
- Built and launched a client portal connecting businesses with their account managers, giving real-time transparency into digital marketing services for active users, including clients in highly regulated industries such as finance and healthcare
- Design and test AI-supported marketing and content workflows, integrating APIs and automation tools across platforms, contributing to client growth initiatives that increased direct traffic 71% and Google search impressions 56% on average
- Create a multi-scenario SaaS model projecting ARR, unit economics (LTV:CAC, churn by tier), and cost structure over 4 years

Drew Dorenfest A/V **Los Angeles, CA (Remote)**
Strategy Intern *May 2025 – August 2025*
- Conducted SEO, social media, and brand research for 5+ long-term clients to inform marketing strategy and creative direction
- Prepared presentations and client materials, gaining exposure to contract dynamics among talent, brands, and production partners

EcoWash **Chicago, IL**
Divisional Manager *April 2024 – August 2024*
- Launched a new regional division in greater Chicago, managing all accounting, budgeting, and weekly cash flow reporting
- Designed and executed a comprehensive multi-channel marketing strategy that generated 250+ leads and converted 50 clients, drafting $500K in detailed project proposals and estimates for high-profile property management firms
- Recruited, trained, and led a team of full-time employees, overseeing scheduling and operations for 50+ projects while ensuring timely, high-quality execution, client satisfaction, and key performance targets

Additional Experience

L'Etoile, *Server* *(July 2026 – Present, 20+ hrs/week)* **Madison, WI**
- Serve 20+ covers per shift at Madison's most acclaimed restaurant, coordinating with front- and back-of-house staff, delivering polished service in a high-stakes fine-dining environment while tailoring each experience to guest preferences

University Recreation and Wellbeing, *Aquatics Supervisor* *(December 2023 – Present, 20+ hrs/week)* **Madison, WI**
- Supervise a team of up to 8 lifeguards, overseeing scheduling, safety compliance, and daily facility operations, and support NCAA swim/dive meets and community events by coordinating logistics and resources with coaches and event staff

Organizational Involvement

WUD (Wisconsin Union Directorate) Music **Madison, WI**
Committee Member *February 2024 – Present*
- Book and promote live performances across 7 Madison venues, using streaming trends and audience data to identify talent
- Negotiate contracts and pricing with booking agents and artists, analyzing artist performance data to inform offers while building strong professional relationships, staying on budget, and maximizing audience engagement

Undergraduate Business Law Association **Madison, WI**
Attorney *January 2026 – Present*
- Develop and deliver structured legal arguments in competitive mock trials, including cross-collaboration with UCLA
- Analyze complex case materials to identify leverage points and risk exposure, applying contract and liability principles

University Theater **Madison, WI**
Lead Actor (Coached by Dr. Baron Kelly) *October 2024 – May 2025*
- Cast as Melchior, the lead role in UW-Madison's 2025 mainstage production of *Spring Awakening*, delivering 8 sold-out performances working alongside professional creative teams, learning how to connect with audiences on an emotional level

Skills and Interests

Technical Skills: Financial modeling, CRM systems, Microsoft Office/Google Workspace (Advanced), AI tools, Java, web/app development
Interests: Making music (cello, piano, guitar), the Packers, traveling (recently went to Sweden), cooking while listening to Stevie Wonder